Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES

A112B
Cultures II

Main – All Branches
Midterm Exam

2025-2026/Second Semester
Date: 14 April 2026
5:00 – 7:00

Number of Exam Pages: 3 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed: 2 Hours**

INSTRUCTIONS

This Exam consists of TWO PARTS.

Part 1 contains 3 Short Answer Questions. You must choose TWO and fully answer them PARAGRAPH FORMAT.

Part 2 contains 2 Essay Questions. You must choose ONE of them and fully answer it in ESSAY FORMAT.

Write the question number next to each answer.

Do not answer more questions than required.

CamScanner

Part 1: Short Answer Questions
(10 points = 5 points for each answer)

Please choose TWO of the following questions and respond to them in paragraph format. Each answer should be approximately 80 words long, addressing all relevant aspects of the question with appropriate evidence from the course material. Ensure that each paragraph includes a clear topic sentence, supporting details, and a conclusion.

1. What is **periphrasis** or **circumlocution**, and how is it used in *Twelfth Night*?
2. How can we define **festive figures**? Who are the **festive characters** in *Twelfth Night*, and **what roles** do they play in the comedy?
3. What is **realism** in literature, and what are its **key characteristics**?

Part 2: Essay Questions
(20 points)

Please choose ONE of the essay prompts below and write a comprehensive response in essay format. Your essay should be around 350 words, covering all relevant aspects of the question and backed by evidence from the course material. Make sure to structure your essay with an introduction, multiple body paragraphs, and a conclusion.

4. Explain how **disguise** (both **physical** and **metaphorical**) drives the **plot** and **themes** of *Twelfth Night* by analyzing the **motives** of three characters who use disguise and the **consequences** their actions create, including love triangles, confusion, comedic effects, and resolution.

   Sub-Questions (20 marks total — 4 marks each)

   a. **Introduction (4 marks)** Define disguise (physical and metaphorical). Name three characters who use disguise in *Twelfth Night* and identify two consequences of their actions.

   b. **Body Paragraph 1 (4 marks)** State Viola's motives for disguising herself as Cesario. How does this disguise create confusion in the plot?

   c. **Body Paragraph 2 (4 marks)** Identify Maria's disguise method and motive. What comedic effects does her disguise produce?

   d. **Body Paragraph 3 (4 marks)** Describe Feste's disguise as Sir Topaz and its motive. What comedic effects and consequences does Feste's disguise create in the play?

   e. **Conclusion (4 marks)** How does disguise function as a driving force in *Twelfth Night's* plot? Explain why Shakespeare uses disguise and how it leads to the play's resolution.

CamScanner

5. Explain how **Jane**, **Helen**, and **Rochester** each represent different struggles for independence, dignity, and moral integrity in ***Jane Eyre***, describing what each character learns and how their journeys drive the novel's themes.

Sub-Questions (20 marks total — 4 marks each)

a. **Introduction (4 marks)** Who are the three main characters in *Jane Eyre* (Jane, Helen, and Rochester)? What does each character struggle with throughout the novel?

b. **Body Paragraph 1 (4 marks)** Describe Jane's struggle in *Jane Eyre*. What does she want for herself? Give two examples of how she refuses to accept unfair treatment and demands to be treated as an equal.

c. **Body Paragraph 2 (4 marks)** Describe Helen Burns's struggle in *Jane Eyre*. How is her way of handling suffering different from Jane's? What does Helen teach Jane about self-respect and inner strength through patience and forgiveness?

d. **Body Paragraph 3 (4 marks)** Describe Rochester's struggle in *Jane Eyre*. What moral failures from his past must he face? How does he change and grow in order to become worthy of Jane's love?

e. **Conclusion (4 marks)** Why are these three characters important to *Jane Eyre*? How do Jane's, Helen's, and Rochester's struggles with independence, dignity, and moral integrity create the novel's main themes?

End of the Exam!

CamScanner